

Juvenile Arthritis School Support Guide for Parents in the UK

Practical NHS-backed advice on juvenile arthritis school support guide for parents uk.

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Quick Answer: Children with juvenile arthritis are entitled to reasonable adjustments at school under the Equality Act 2010. These include flexible start times for morning stiffness, seating adaptations, rest breaks, support with writing, and an Individual Healthcare Plan (IHP). Start by meeting with the school's SENCO.

Navigating school with juvenile idiopathic arthritis (JIA) requires coordination between parents, school, and healthcare team. With the right support, most children with JIA can participate fully in school life.

Your Child's Legal Rights

JIA is likely a disability under the Equality Act 2010, requiring schools to make reasonable adjustments. Schools must have an Individual Healthcare Plan (IHP) for any pupil with a medical condition under the Children and Families Act 2014.

What to Include in the IHP

- Medication storage and administration arrangements
- Adapted PE participation guidelines
- Seating requirements (supportive chair, not floor sitting)
- Permission to carry a water bottle
- Extended time for assessments

- Plan for managing flares and extended absences
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Practical Adaptations



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Morning stiffness from JIA can make early school starts very difficult. Discuss a later arrival arrangement with the school. Children with hand involvement may need support with writing — laptop use, extra time in exams, and scribe arrangements are all reasonable adjustments schools should provide.

Q&A;

Question: Does my child need an EHCP for juvenile arthritis? **Short answer:** An EHCP is appropriate if JIA significantly affects educational progress and standard SEND support is

insufficient. Many children can be supported without an EHCP through an IHP and reasonable adjustments.

Question: Can the school refuse to administer my child's medication? **Short answer:** Schools cannot refuse to administer medication with parental consent under current DfE guidance. They must have written consent and an agreed medication procedure.

Question: Where can I get more support as a parent? **Short answer:** Versus Arthritis has dedicated children and young people resources for parents and schools. Your paediatric rheumatology team can also provide letters explaining your child's needs.

General information only — not medical advice. Consult your GP or specialist before changing medication or starting a new programme. Emergency: 999. NHS advice: 111. Living With Arthritis UK · livingwitharthritis.org.uk